

Madison Levine

Department of Agricultural and Consumer Economics
University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

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Research Fields: Development Economics, Behavioral Economics

Secondary Fields: Risk and Uncertainty, Agricultural Economics

Education

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign 2022–Present

Ph.D. in Agricultural and Applied Economics (Expected 2027)

Advisor: Sarah Janzen

Honors: Best Second Year Paper Award (2024)

University of San Francisco 2019

M.S., International and Development Economics

Advisor: Alessandra Cassar

Saint Mary's College of California 2017

B.A., Economics

Publications

- [1] N. Meriggi, M. Voors, **M. Levine**, . . . , A. Mobarak et al. [Last-Mile Delivery Increases Vaccine Uptake in Sierra Leone](#). *Nature*, 627: 612–619, 2024.
- [2] **M. Levine** et al. [Gendered Disparities during the COVID-19 Crisis in Sierra Leone](#). *AEA Papers and Proceedings*, 113: 567–571, 2023.
- [3] J.S. Solis Arce, S.S. Warren, N.F. Meriggi et al. [COVID-19 Vaccine Acceptance and Hesitancy in Low- and Middle-Income Countries](#). *Nature Medicine*, 27: 1385–1394, 2021.

Working Papers

Loss Aversion and Agricultural Investment: Experimental Evidence from Smallholder Farmers in Kenya
Job Market Paper

(with Sarah Janzen, Berber Kramer, and Kelvin Shikuku)

See It Grow: A Randomized Evaluation of a Digital Innovation to Improve Crop Insurance Contract Design
(with Berber Kramer, Francesco Cecchi, and Lilian Waithaka)

[CGIAR Discussion Paper \(2025\)](#)

Work in Progress

Policymakers' Preferences for Pre-Arranged Financing: Evidence from Disaster Risk Financing Experiments in Africa

(with Berber Kramer et al.)

Research Experience

Consultant, International Food Policy Research Institute (IFPRI) 2025–2026

Nairobi, Kenya

- Designed and implemented a tablet-based experimental game for field data collection (Flutter, Android)

Studio)

- Co-developed a theoretical model and generated structural predictions
- Built Python pipelines for data extraction and processing
- Conducted empirical analysis in Stata and contributed to donor reports

Research Assistant, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

2024–2025

Advisor: Sarah Janzen

- Contributed to research on credit access, risk, and investment among smallholder farmers in Kenya
- Led development of a tablet-based experimental financial decision-making tool
- Implemented dynamic optimization models in Python for household investment under risk

Senior Research Associate, Wageningen University & Research

2019–2022

Freetown, Sierra Leone

- Managed and implemented multiple large-scale randomized controlled trials in development economics
- Led a three-phase impact evaluation of a solar mini-grid program across 194 communities
- Conducted causal analysis using difference-in-differences methods (Stata)
- Contributed to research design, grant writing, and donor reporting

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant, Intermediate Microeconomics (ACE 300), UIUC

Fall 2025

Teaching Assistant, World Food Economy (ACE 251), UIUC

Fall 2023

Teaching Assistant, Introduction to Microeconomics, USF

2018–2019

Presentations

See It Grow: A Randomized Evaluation of a Digital Innovation to Improve Crop Insurance Contract Design, Midwest International Economic Development Conference, 2026

Impacts of Risk Transfer on Agricultural Investments, AAEA Annual Meeting, 2026

Loss Aversion and Agricultural Investment, AAEA Annual Meeting, 2026

Demand for Risk Management Tools, ACRE Africa, 2025

Grants and Awards

Global Food Security Graduate Fellowship, UIUC

2024 (\$6,720)

Graduate Student International Research Grant, UIUC

2024 (\$4,000)

Best Second Year Paper Award, UIUC

2024

Skills

Stata (proficient), Python (intermediate), R (intermediate), L^AT_EX, Android Studio, Flutter, QGIS

SurveyCTO, ODK, Survey Solutions, Kobo

English (native), Spanish (intermediate)

References

Sarah Janzen (Chair)

Associate Professor

University of Illinois

sjanzen@illinois.edu

Berber Kramer

Senior Research Fellow

IFPRI

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Hope Michelson

Professor

University of Illinois

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Nick Paulson

Professor

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